

Mastering Bug Reporting for QA Professionals

Tips for writing clear, actionable bug reports, and best practices for bug reporting that help developers fix issues quickly.



Nuwan Abeywickrama
[@nuwanabeywickrama](https://twitter.com/nuwanabeywickrama)

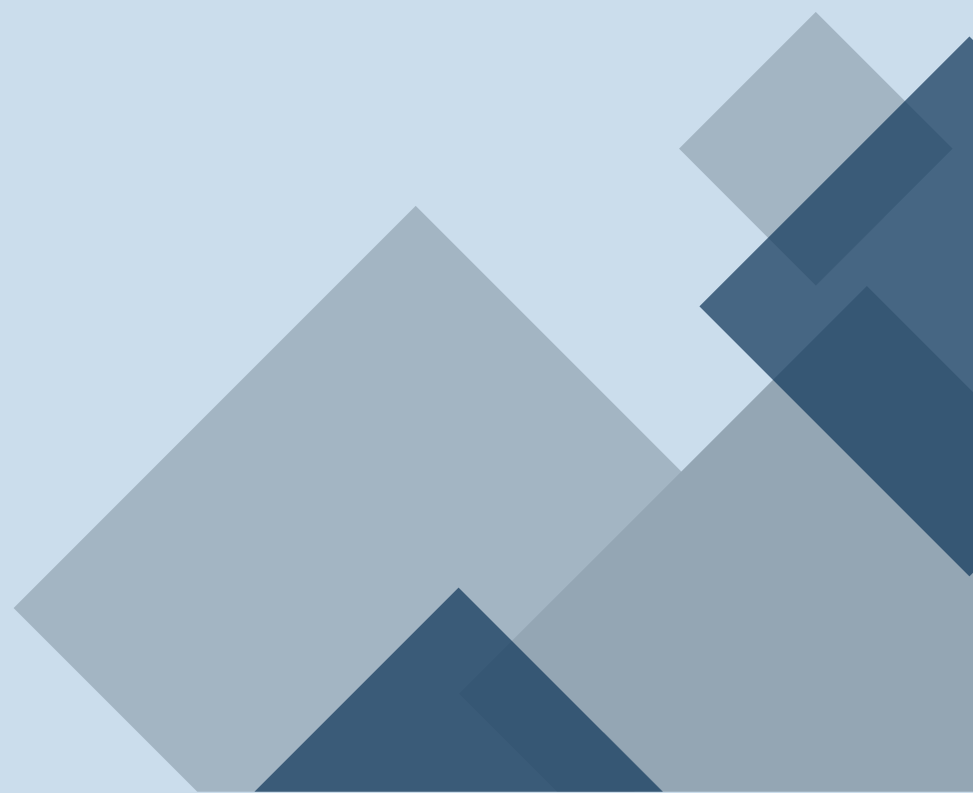


Introduction to Bug Reporting

Bug reporting is a crucial part of the software development process.

Clear and detailed bug reports help developers understand, reproduce, and fix issues faster.

A well-written bug report can save time, avoid confusion, and improve the overall quality of the product.



Importance of Clear Bug Reporting

Reduce Developer Frustration - A poorly reported bug can lead to delays, confusion, and miscommunication. Developers need clarity to reproduce the issue quickly.

Improve Team Efficiency - A clear bug report allows for faster debugging and better collaboration between testers and developers.

Track and Monitor - Well-documented bugs are easier to track, prioritize, and ensure they are resolved on time.



Key Components of a Good Bug Report

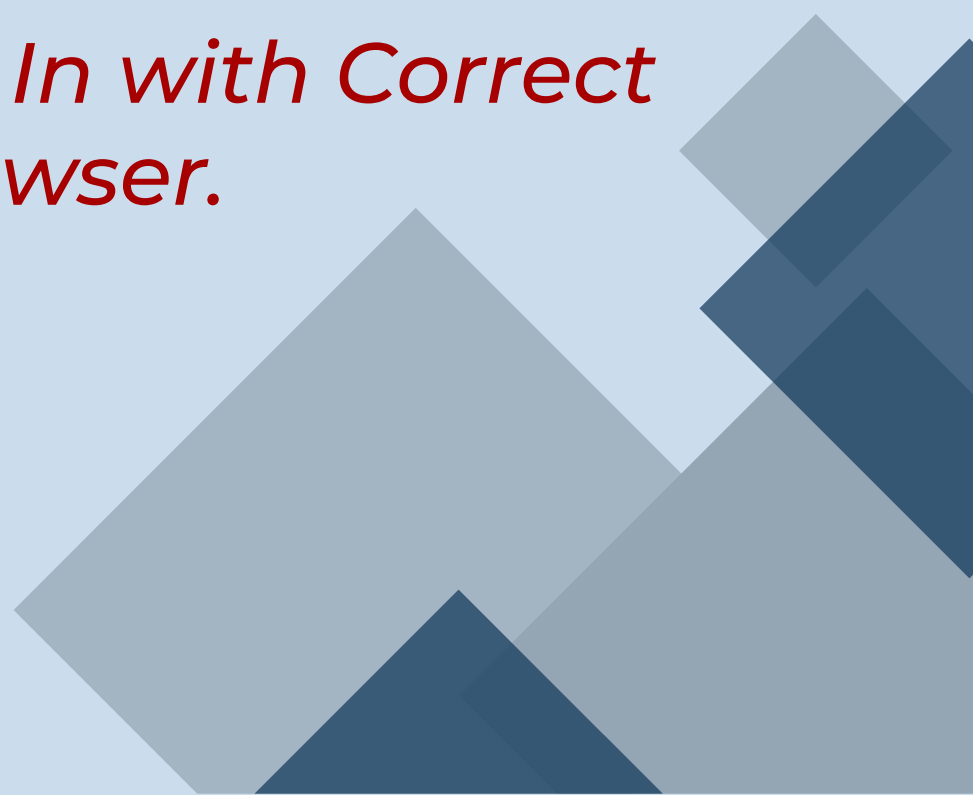
1. Clear and Descriptive Title

The bug title should summarize the issue, focusing on the problem, and then include the platform, browser, or environment when relevant.

Examples:

Login button unresponsive on mobile (Android 11, Chrome).

Login Error: Unable to Sign In with Correct Credentials on Chrome Browser.



2. Steps to Reproduce

List the exact steps that led to the issue. Include details such as the actions performed, user role, environment, and data used.

Example:

- 1. Go to the login page.*
- 2. Enter valid credentials.*
- 3. Click the "Login" button.*
- 4. Observe no response.*



3. Attachments (Logs, Screenshots, Videos)

Attachments such as logs, screenshots, or video recordings to provide more context. This helps developers quickly visualize or replicate the issue.

4. Expected vs Actual Results

Expected result means what should happen when the steps are followed while Actual result means what actually happened during the testing.

Example:

Expected - The user should be logged in.

Actual - Nothing happens, the page remains static.



5. Severity and Priority

Classify the bug based on its impact (Severity: Critical, Major, Minor) and urgency (Priority: High, Medium, Low).

- Severity - Application point of view.
- Priority - User point of view.

Example:

Severity: Major – blocking user login.
Priority: High.



4. Environment Details

Include the environment where the bug occurred (OS, browser version, device, network conditions).

Example:

Type 01

Android 11, Chrome v91, Wi-Fi.

Type 02

- *OS: Windows 10*
- *Browser: Google Chrome v92.0*
- *Device: Desktop*
- *App Version: v2.3.1*
- *Network: Wi-Fi, 50 Mbps*



Common Mistakes in Bug Reporting

- **Vague Descriptions**
“Login not working” is too broad. A detailed description of the bug is a must.
- **Missing Steps to Reproduce**
- **No Expected vs Actual Results**
Without expected and actual results, it is harder to understand the nature of the bug.
- **Incomplete Environment Information**
Incomplete environment details can lead to confusion.
- **Lack of Attachments**
Failing to provide attachments increases the investigation time.



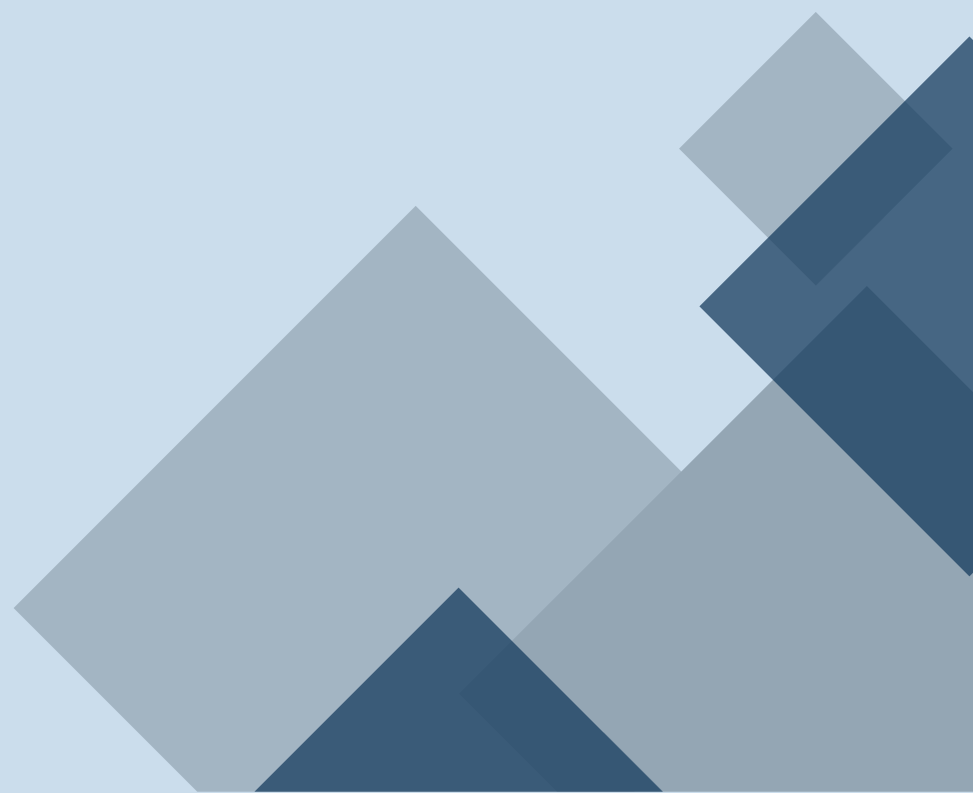
Best Practices for Bug Reporting

- **Be Specific and Detailed**
- **Use Clear Language**
- **Provide Context**
Explain where the bug was found (e.g., "This bug occurred after deploying the latest patch").
- **Test Reproducibility**
Confirm whether the bug is consistent or intermittent. If intermittent, mention how often it occurs (2 out of 5 attempts).
- **Prioritize and Classify**
Assign the correct severity and priority so developers know how to prioritize fixes.



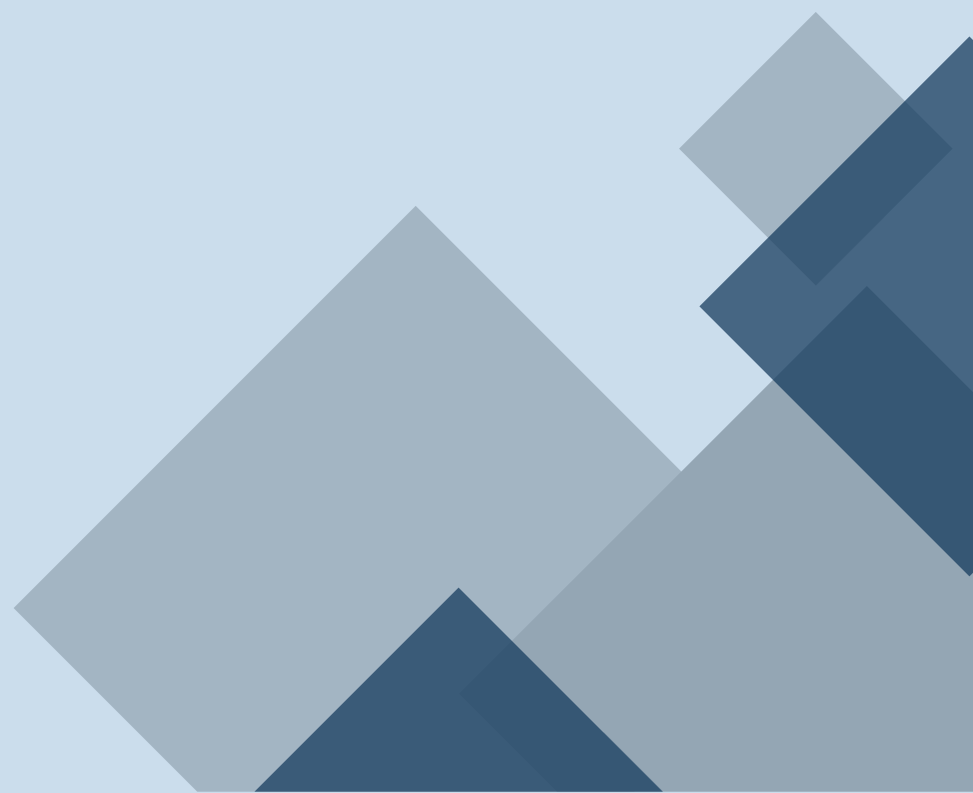
How to Improve Bug Report Communication

- **Collaborate with Developers**
- **Use Templates**
- **Encourage Regular Reviews**
Review bug reports as a team to ensure high-quality submissions.
- **Automate Where Possible**
Use automation tools to capture logs and screenshots to supplement manual reporting.



Common Bug Reporting Tools

- JIRA
- Bugzilla
- Asana
- GitHub Issues



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